

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 9 7 4
♥ J 10 4 3
♦ J 7 6
♣ 10 8

♠ A 6 3

♥ 9 7

♦ Q 8 4

♣ A K Q 6 2



♠ Q J 10 5 2

♥ Q

♦ A 9 5 2

♣ 9 5 3

♠ 8

♥ A K 8 6 5 2

♦ K 10 3

♣ J 7 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = ? : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = ?

The loser count is very confused, but that ♣ suit is not confused at all. You want to be able to run the ♣s so your plan is to play the ♥ A K, and if both defenders follow go ahead and knock out the last ♥ so they can't ruff your ♣ tricks.

Unfortunately when you play ♥ A K, East plays the ♥ Q, then discards a ♠.

You may think you should change your plan but you should go right ahead with it. West has two master trumps, but dummy still has 4 small ones. So play a ♥ to force out West's ♥ 10. He will no doubt play another ♠ and force dummy to ruff. No problem, knock out West's final ♥ and dummy will still have one tiny trump left. When you get back in you can run the ♣s unimpeded.

Usually it is good technique to leave master trump(s) undrawn.

The exception is when you have a long suit you wish to run and you can't stand to have the running stopped by a ruff.

This Deal is unusual in that there are two master trumps, but the principle is the same.

Who knows whether you should use a transfer or just bid 4♥ yourself. Assume you decide on the transfer and bid 2♦. Partner bids 2♥ (of course).

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Naturally you go ahead and bid 4♥, the final contract.

The contract would be 4♥ played by South.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠ Q and West follows with the ♠ 9.

You win the first trick with the ♠ A.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 6
♥ J 10 7 6
♦ A 6 5
♣ Q 7 5

♠ 8 2

♥ Q 9

♦ J 7 3

♣ J 9 8 6 3 2

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♠ Q J 9 5 3

♥ K 4 3

♦ K 8 2

♣ 10 4

♠ A 7 4

♥ A 8 5 2

♦ Q 10 9 4

♣ A K

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♣
All Pass			
3♣ by South			

The 2♠ bid is used as a transfer to 3♣.

If you don't use this in your system, just consider this hand; you might decide to incorporate it. So you bid 3♣ and everybody passes.

South plays 3♣. West leads the ♥J.

You play dummy's ♥Q hopefully, but East plays the ♥K.

Loser List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 5

That is one loser too many. The ♣Q MIGHT drop . . . but she won't. There are no finesse positions. So you are going to have to establish a winner somewhere to discard dummy's small ♠.

Do you see it? The ♥8. Take the ♥A. Then play your ♣ A K. As predicted, the ♣Q doesn't fall. Then play a small ♥ to dummy's ♥9. Of course West will take the ♥10, but now your ♥8 is high.

As soon as you get the lead you play the ♥8 and discard dummy's ♠2.

We know, you didn't really play the ♥Q on the first trick in the hope that West had underled the ♥K (although he certainly might have done so).

The real reason for covering was so you could establish the ♥8 by force.

Suppose you had not played the ♥Q to trick one. East would have withheld the ♥K and you'd have had to take your ♥A. Later East would have taken dummy's ♥Q with his ♥K, then played a small ♥ through your ♥8 to West's ♥10 7.

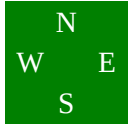
Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 2
♥ J 10 9
♦ J 8 6 3
♣ 8 7 5 4 2

♠ Q 10 8 5
♥ A Q 7
♦ K Q 9 2
♣ A 6



♠ 9 6 4
♥ K 6 5 2
♦ 10 7
♣ Q J 10 3

♠ A K J 7 3
♥ 8 4 3
♦ A 5 4
♣ K 9

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♠	Pass	6♠
All Pass			
6♠ by North			